Build Exercise — AI Solutions Builder

RE Financial Services Private Limited

About us, and about this exercise

We're a full-service finance and accounting firm for entrepreneurs — month-end close, FP&A, fractional CFO, and SEC reporting — operating across the US and India, and building as an AI-native firm. You'd be our founding AI hire, working directly with a founding partner who owns product direction. Your job would be to build: connecting our systems to Claude and turning our accountants' expertise into Claude skills, backed by evaluations that prove they work.

This exercise is a small, real version of that job. We are evaluating how you build and test — not your accounting knowledge. Our team supplies the accounting judgment; you supply the engineering of it. You are encouraged to use Claude, Claude Code, and any resources you like while building — that's the job.

Your environment and your data

The sandbox: create a free Intuit developer account at developer.intuit.com — it comes with your own QuickBooks Online sandbox company automatically. Setting this up yourself is part of the exercise; no credentials from us are required, and nothing you connect touches real data. Treat your own keys with the same discipline you would a client's.

The data: we'll provide an Excel workbook with 18 months of monthly financial statements for a fictional company — several revenue streams, payroll, operating expense categories, some seasonality and one-off events. This workbook is the primary data source for your trend analysis.

The exercise — four parts

1. **Connect your QuickBooks sandbox to Claude**, securely and reliably. Your choice of method — a native connector, an open-source MCP server you deploy, or a custom MCP built on the QuickBooks API. Demonstrate the connection working against the sandbox (its default sample data is fine for this). Document what you chose, what you rejected, and why — including where this would run if a whole team (not just your laptop) needed to use it, and how credentials are handled throughout.
2. **Build a Claude skill** that produces a monthly trend analysis from the provided Excel workbook, for a human reviewer to finish: revenue, margins, and operating expenses by

category, with month-over-month and trailing-twelve-month views, and short written commentary flagging the movements a business owner should know about. Structure it so a teammate could read, maintain, and extend it — and point it at a different company's data without a rewrite. **Stretch goal**: load the workbook's data into your sandbox and run the same skill end-to-end through the live connection.

3. **Build an eval suite**. **At least five golden cases** — a data state paired with the expected analysis output — and a concrete description of how you'd grade the system against them and how you'd detect a regression after a future change. We care about this a lot: it's how we know anything we build actually works.
4. **Write one page on your architecture:** how you structured the project (files, skills, memory), your hosting choices, and what changes when this runs for ten different clients — including how you'd keep each client's data separate.

What you'll deliver

- The working connection (whatever form it takes — config, deployed server, code).
- The skill file(s).
- The eval cases and your grading approach.
- The one-page architecture note.

The final round: a live readout (45 minutes, video call)

After you submit, we'll evaluate your deliverables. If you're selected for the final round, we'll invite you to a live readout: you'll demo the working system — the sandbox connection and the trend analysis — bring the real thing, not slides. Expect us to ask for one small modification on the spot, to ask why you structured things the way you did, what your evals caught while you were building, and what breaks first at ten clients. The last few minutes are for your questions.

What we're looking for

Five things, weighted equally: a connection choice you can defend (including the team-hosting answer — reasoning matters more than whether you've deployed one before); careful credential and data handling throughout; a skill a teammate could maintain and extend; evals that can tell better from worse; and clear, honest communication about what works and what doesn't.

Ground rules

- Use any tools, models, documentation, or open-source components you like — building with AI is expected, not penalized. Just be ready to explain every choice as your own.
- Keep everything within your developer sandbox and the workbook we provide; don't connect any live accounts or real data.
- Questions during the week are welcome.